

The peace-love sentiments of the psychedelic era coincided with the last hurrah in the stock market, which peaked in a speculative frenzy with new all-time highs in such secondary-stock-dominated indexes as the "Value" Line. A string of "Bubble Gum" hits made the charts, a sickly-sweet extreme in trend if ever there was one. At the same time, the pop music groups and stars who had shaped the topping phase abruptly fell from favor.

As the negative mood developed, slow ballad artists began gaining in popularity. The ballad-buyers felt depressed, while the kids felt angry. Background music for the bear market, which dated from 1966 and accelerated in 1969, increasingly was supplied by bands whose accent was on the negative, stressing themes of war (as opposed to peace), hate (as opposed to love), sex (in place of love songs) and the devil. Heavy metal bands, which had originally been satisfied to present merely a noisy, foreboding sound, adopted a calculated theatrical approach to their recordings and performances, and suggested darkness, sexual ambiguity and general nastiness.

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The most extreme musical development of the mid-1970's was punk rock. The lyrics of these compositions, as pointed out by Tom Landess, associate editor of *The Southern Partisan*, resembled T.S. Eliot's classic poem "The Waste Land." The attendant music was anti-"musical" (i.e., non-melodic, relying on one or two chords and two or three melody notes, screaming vocals, little or no vocal harmony, dissonance and noise). Punk musicians made it a point as artists to be non-musical minimalists and to create ugliness. Their reign ended with the bear market in stocks in the early 1980's.